



Personal Survival Techniques (PST)

210 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

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Practice Set 1

Q1. Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon (EPIRB) is considered as:

- A) Primary means of alerting device
- B) Secondary means of alerting device
- C) Both primary and secondary
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: B (Secondary means of alerting device)

Explanation: An EPIRB is a secondary means of alerting, as the primary means is typically through GMDSS radio communications (DSC) initiated from the bridge. The EPIRB serves as a reliable emergency beacon for locating the vessel during abandonment.

Q2. How can a Search and Rescue Radar Transponder (SART) effective range be maximized?

- A) The SART should be placed in water immediately after activation
- B) The SART should be put on high power mode
- C) Mount the SART horizontally with respect to rescue vessel radar
- D) It should be as high as possible

Correct Answer: D (It should be as high as possible)

Explanation: A SART operates by reflecting radar signals from search and rescue vessels. Because it is a line-of-sight device, keeping it as high as possible above the sea surface significantly increases its detection range by radar scanners.

Q3. On a passenger ship, muster of passengers must be carried out:

- A) Within one week after boarding the person
- B) Within 24 hours of leaving the port
- C) Whenever the passengers are settled out
- D) Anytime by surprise as decided by the master

Correct Answer: B (Within 24 hours of leaving the port)

Explanation: Passenger safety is paramount. Regulations require that passengers be mustered and instructed in emergency procedures, including the use of lifejackets and knowledge of the assembly station, within 24 hours of boarding.

Q4. The Thermal Protective Aid (TPA) should permit the wearer to remove it in the water:

- A) Not more than two minutes
- B) Not more than five minutes
- C) Not more than 10 minutes
- D) Not more than 15 minutes

Correct Answer: A (Not more than two minutes)

Explanation: A Thermal Protective Aid (TPA) is designed to protect survivors from hypothermia. LSA regulations require that the



~~Q5. Which channel is designated as the VHF follow-on Communication channel required in all portable survival craft equipment?~~

- A) Channel 06
- B) Channel 70
- C) Channel 13
- D) Channel 16

Correct Answer: D (Channel 16)

Explanation: VHF Channel 16 is the international distress and safety frequency, and it is the designated channel for all follow-on communications between a survival craft and the assisting rescue vessel.

Q6. How many survival craft VHF walkie-talkies are required to be carried on cargo ships above 500 Gross Registered Tonnage (GRT)?

- A) Two numbers
- B) Three numbers
- C) Four numbers
- D) Five numbers

Correct Answer: B (Three numbers)

Explanation: SOLAS regulations require that cargo ships of 500 GRT and above carry at least three two-way VHF radiotelephone apparatuses for use in survival craft to ensure communication with rescue vessels during abandonment.

Q7. You are at sea in an inflatable life raft in high altitudes, the greatest danger is:

- A) Collapse of the raft due to cold temperatures
- B) Asphyxiation due to keeping the canopy closed
- C) Hypothermia caused by cold temperature
- D) Starvation

Correct Answer: C (Hypothermia caused by cold temperature)

Explanation: In a survival craft, the lack of thermal protection and the inability to generate body heat in a wet environment makes hypothermia the primary killer. While cold can affect air pressure, the human physiological limit is the most critical factor.

Q8. Prior to lowering the lifeboat, the most important item to check is:

- A) Oars
- B) Sail
- C) Boat plug
- D) Life preservers

Correct Answer: C (Boat plug)

Explanation: The boat plug, often called a drain plug, must be securely inserted before lowering the lifeboat. If omitted, the boat will flood immediately upon launching, potentially leading to swamping or sinking.



- A) Nature of distress
- B) Time of the day
- C) Your radio call sign
- D) Your position by latitude and longitude

Correct Answer: D (Your position by latitude and longitude)

Explanation: Under GMDSS and IAMSAR procedures, the most essential data for an effective search is the precise geographic location. Latitude and longitude allow the Rescue Coordination Centre (RCC) to direct assets to the correct area.

Q10. What is the type of battery used for EPIRB and your SART?

- A) Lead acid battery
- B) Solar rechargeable cells
- C) Lithium non-rechargeable
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Lithium non-rechargeable)

Explanation: EPIRBs and SARTs require reliable, long-lasting power sources. Lithium batteries are used because they offer a long shelf-life, high energy density, and reliability in extreme temperatures.

Q11. Which statement concerning locating signals in the GMDSS is false?

- A) Locating signals are transmitted by survival craft VHF transceivers
- B) Locating signals are transmitted by search and rescue radar transponders
- C) Locating signals are intended to facilitate the finding of distress vessel or survivors
- D) Locating signals are not transmitted by auto alarm generators

Correct Answer: A (Locating signals are transmitted by survival craft VHF transceivers)

Explanation: Survival craft VHF transceivers are communication devices, not 'locating signals' within the context of GMDSS. Locating signals, such as SARTs or AIS-SART, are specifically designed to be detected by radar or AIS for target identification.

Q12. The person aboard a vessel signaling by raising and lowering his or her outstretched arms to each side is indicating:

- A) Danger, stay away
- B) All is clear, it is safe to pass
- C) All is clear, it is safe to approach
- D) A distress signal

Correct Answer: D (A distress signal)

Explanation: According to the International Aeronautical and Maritime Search and Rescue (IAMSAR) manual and COLREGs Annex IV, this physical gesture is a recognized visual signal of distress.

Q13. You are involved in an emergency landing of a helicopter in water. You should inflate your life jacket:

- A) Upon entering the helicopter
- B) Prior to reaching the water
- C) After reaching the water but prior to exiting the helicopter
- D) After clear of the helicopter

Correct Answer: D (After clear of the helicopter)

Explanation: Inflating a life jacket inside a capsizing helicopter can trap the occupant and prevent escape through narrow exits. It must be inflated only once the survivor is clear of the fuselage to ensure buoyancy.

Q14. Choose the right combination of VHF channels for emergency communication during search and rescue for ship-to-ship and ship-to-aircraft communication:



- A) Channel 21 and 23
- B) Channel 06 and 30
- C) Channel 16 and 06
- D) Channel 70 and 16

Correct Answer: C (Channel 16 and 06)

Explanation: Channel 16 is the international distress, safety, and calling frequency. Channel 06 is the primary designated inter-ship safety channel for coordinated search and rescue operations.

Q15. Davit-launched life raft can be boarded:

- A) From the water only
- B) At the deck
- C) By jumping down onto it
- D) Through the escape tube

Correct Answer: B (At the deck)

Explanation: Davit-launched life rafts are designed to be inflated and boarded at the embarkation deck, allowing survivors to enter the craft safely before it is lowered into the water.

Q16. Cargo ships of 100 meters and above but less than 150 meters should have how many life buoys?

- A) 8
- B) 12
- C) 30
- D) 14

Correct Answer: C (30)

Explanation: According to SOLAS Chapter III, ships of 100 meters and upwards but less than 150 meters in length must carry a minimum of 12 lifebuoys.

Q17. Which onboard equipment will detect a signal from a search and rescue radar transponder (SART)?

- A) S-band radar
- B) Digital selective calling (DSC) receiver
- C) Satellite communication terminals
- D) X-band radar

Correct Answer: D (X-band radar)

Explanation: A SART is designed to operate in the 9 GHz band (X-band). When pulsed by an X-band radar, the SART sends back a specific response that appears on the radar display as a line of 12 dots.

Q18. With a sprinkler system and air system on and all hatches shut, the survival craft will provide protection from:

- A) Nuclear environment
- B) Fire and toxic environment
- C) Storm or a hurricane
- D) Sea creatures

Correct Answer: B (Fire and toxic environment)

Explanation: Enclosed survival craft feature water spray systems for hull cooling and air support systems (compressed air cylinders)



~~Q19. What must be the characteristics of a lifebuoy attached with a self-igniting light and smoke?~~

- A) Two hours of light with two candle luminous intensity with 15 minutes of smoke
- B) One hour of light with 15 minutes of smoke
- C) Two hours of light with two hours of smoke
- D) 15 minutes of light with 15 minutes of smoke

Correct Answer: A (Two hours of light with two candle luminous intensity with 15 minutes of smoke)

Explanation: SOLAS requirements state that a lifebuoy with a self-igniting light must provide at least 2 cd for 2 hours, and a smoke signal must provide at least 15 minutes of smoke.

Q20. The most important reason for taking anti-seasickness pills as soon as possible after entering into a life raft is to:

- A) Assist in sleeping
- B) Reduce appetite by decreasing nausea
- C) Prevent loss of body moisture by vomiting
- D) Prevent impact judgment due to motion-induced deliriousness

Correct Answer: C (Prevent loss of body moisture by vomiting)

Explanation: Seasickness induces vomiting, which leads to rapid dehydration. In a survival situation, maintaining hydration is critical to longevity, making early prevention of fluid loss vital.

Q21. The rescue vessel is approaching an activated SART at a distance of five miles. What indication appears on the rescue vessel radar screen?

- A) SOS symbol appears on the display of the radar screen
- B) Concentric circles
- C) A series of 12 equally spaced blips outward from the SART's position along its line of bearing
- D) Wide arcs

Correct Answer: C (A series of 12 equally spaced blips outward from the SART's position along its line of bearing)

Explanation: When a SART is within range, it responds to the ship's X-band radar pulses by displaying a series of 12 dots spaced 0.6 nautical miles apart along the line of bearing from the radar.

Q22. On what frequency do EPIRBs transmit information to satellites on emergency activation?

- A) 121.5 MHz
- B) 243 MHz
- C) 156.8 MHz
- D) 406 MHz

Correct Answer: D (406 MHz)

Explanation: 406 MHz is the frequency dedicated for satellite-based distress alerting via the Cospas-Sarsat system, which provides global coverage and identifies the vessel.



- A) Oil pollution
- B) Building of compartments
- C) Damage to the ship
- D) Possibility of capsizing

Correct Answer: D (Possibility of capsizing)

Explanation: After a collision, loss of intact stability or reserve buoyancy due to flooding leads to capsizing, which is the most immediate threat to the lives of all personnel on board.

Q24. What should be the duration and luminous intensity of a hand flare?

- A) 60 seconds with 30,000 candles
- B) 60 seconds with 15,000 candles
- C) 120 seconds with 30,000 candles
- D) 120 seconds with 15,000 candles

Correct Answer: B (60 seconds with 15,000 candles)

Explanation: SOLAS LSA Code mandates that hand flares must have a luminous intensity of at least 15,000 candela and burn for a minimum of 60 seconds.

Q25. One of the main characteristics of a life jacket is:

- A) To swim
- B) To maintain the face of an unconscious person above the water level
- C) To float
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: B (To maintain the face of an unconscious person above the water level)

Explanation: A key requirement for a life jacket is the ability to turn an unconscious person's face out of the water within a specified time, preventing drowning.

Q26. Crew duties to passengers in an emergency especially in a passenger vessel involve:

- A) Warn all passengers
- B) Keeping the movement of the passengers towards the muster station
- C) Seeing that they have suitably donned the life jackets in a correct manner
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: During an emergency, the crew is responsible for the safety of passengers, which includes alerting them, guiding them to muster stations, and ensuring lifejackets are donned correctly.

Q27. What indication does an EPIRB give on activation?

- A) Voice prompt saying EPIRB is activated
- B) Strobe lights or flashes on top of the EPIRB
- C) Gives out a printout of distress message sent
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: B (Strobe lights or flashes on top of the EPIRB)

Explanation: EPIRBs are required to have a visual indicator, typically a flashing strobe light, which assists rescuers in locating the unit during nighttime or low-visibility operations.



- A) Two
- B) Four
- C) Six
- D) None

Correct Answer: D (None)

Explanation: Buoyant smoke signals are typically associated with lifebuoys or lifeboats, but for the bridge area specifically, the carriage requirement for buoyant orange smoke floats is zero.

Q29. A life jacket has:

- A) Whistle and light
- B) Reflective tape
- C) Whistle, reflective tape, and a light
- D) Only a whistle

Correct Answer: C (Whistle, reflective tape, and a light)

Explanation: Modern SOLAS-compliant life jackets must be equipped with a whistle to attract attention and a light to provide visibility in dark or low-light conditions.

Q30. How do you know how many persons a lifeboat can accommodate?

- A) Ask your chief officer
- B) No limitations, you can put maximum persons inside
- C) Number of persons it can hold is clearly marked on the outside of the lifeboat
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: C (Number of persons it can hold is clearly marked on the outside of the lifeboat)

Explanation: The maximum number of persons permitted on board a survival craft must be clearly and permanently marked on the exterior of the craft for quick reference during an emergency.

Practice Set 2

Q1. The number of lifebuoys on ship is dependent on:

- A) What owners provide
- B) Minimum of 10
- C) Minimum of 15
- D) Length of the vessel

Correct Answer: D (Length of the vessel)

Explanation: SOLAS regulations specify the number of lifebuoys based on the length of the vessel (e.g., under 100m, 100-150m, etc.).

Q2. EPIRB stands for:

- A) Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon
- B) Emergency Position Indicating Radar Beacon
- C) Escape Position Indicating Radar Beacon
- D) Escape Position Indicating Radio Beacon

Correct Answer: A (Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon)



Q3. Which of the following requirements for Immersion suit is correct?

- A) Donned within 2 minutes
- B) Allow the wearer to jump from 4.5m
- C) Allow the wearer to climb a vertical ladder of 5mtrs
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Immersion suits must meet stringent LSA code standards, including rapid donning, the ability to jump safely, and mobility for tasks like climbing ladders.

Q4. How much faster does the human body lose heat in the water?

- A) 10
- B) 20
- C) 26
- D) 36

Correct Answer: C (26)

Explanation: The human body loses heat approximately 26 times faster in water than in air of the same temperature, making cold water exposure a life-threatening emergency.

Q5. When person floating in the water in group, they should be in:

- A) Help position
- B) Huddle position
- C) Yoga position
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: B (Huddle position)

Explanation: The Huddle position reduces the exposed surface area of the body and promotes shared body heat among survivors, significantly delaying the onset of hypothermia.

Q6. How should the painter of a liferaft which is fitted with hydrostatic release unit be secured to the ship?

- A) Secured via weak link to a secured point on the ship
- B) Secured to the part of hydrostatic release that is designed to break free
- C) It should not be secured anyway
- D) Directly to a secure point on the ship

Correct Answer: A (Secured via weak link to a secured point on the ship)

Explanation: The painter is the line that triggers the inflation of the raft; it must be connected via a weak link so the raft can break free if the ship sinks before the raft is manually released.

Q7. LTA is used as:

- A) Messenger line
- B) Heaving line
- C) Mooring Line
- D) Lashing line

Correct Answer: A (Messenger line)

Explanation: LTA stands for Line Throwing Apparatus. It is used to fire a rocket-propelled line to another ship or shore as a



~~Q8. Life jacket light shall be capable of providing luminous intensity of _____ for a period of _____:~~

- A) .75cd/8hrs
- B) .50cd/8hrs
- C) .75cd/6hrs
- D) .50cd/6hrs

Correct Answer: A (.75cd/8hrs)

Explanation: SOLAS LSA Code requires that a life jacket light must provide a luminous intensity of at least 0.75 cd for a period of at least 8 hours.

Q9. Lifeboat must be stowed in such a way that they can be launched in _____ mins:

- A) 10 mins
- B) 15 mins
- C) 20 mins
- D) 05 mins

Correct Answer: A (10 mins)

Explanation: SOLAS requires that for cargo ships, lifeboats must be capable of being boarded and launched in less than 10 minutes from the time the abandon ship signal is given.

Q10. A distress signal on deck:

- A) Pyrotechnics
- B) Open fire
- C) NC Flag
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: In an emergency, all available means to attract attention, including pyrotechnics, fire, and recognized flag signals (like N over C), should be used.

Q11. SART stands for:

- A) Search and Rescue Radar Transponder
- B) Search and Rescue Radar Transformer
- C) Search and Rescue Radar Transmission
- D) Search and Rescue Radar Transmitter

Correct Answer: A (Search and Rescue Radar Transponder)

Explanation: SART is the acronym for Search and Rescue Radar Transponder, which acts as a secondary aid to help rescue craft locate survivors via their onboard radar.

Q12. Your vessel has been in collision and you are not sure if your vessel is sinking or not, How will you handle this situation?

- A) Make sure that the lifeboat has as much fuel as possible and make your course for nearest land
- B) Wait and see how the situation is developing
- C) Search for missing person, continue to monitor the situation and prepare for event management in case it becomes necessary
- D) Leave the vessel and stay not closer than 5 NM



Correct Answer: C (Search for missing person, continue to monitor the situation and prepare for event management i

Explanation: In a potential sinking, the priority is to account for all personnel (search), maintain awareness of the ship's integrity (monitor), and prepare emergency systems (contingency).

Q13. What is a fire wire?

- A) Wire for pulling burning ships off the pier
- B) Wire for handling fire bucket
- C) Wire for pulling fire hoses upto the top bridge
- D) Wire for securing smoke divers

Correct Answer: A (Wire for pulling burning ships off the pier)

Explanation: A fire wire is a wire rope provided on tankers at the bow and stern to enable tugs to pull the vessel away from a pier in the event of a fire.

Q14. Quantity of water in lifeboat per person:

- A) 3Ltrs
- B) 5Ltrs
- C) 4Ltrs
- D) 2Ltrs

Correct Answer: A (3Ltrs)

Explanation: SOLAS requires 3 liters of fresh water per person for lifeboats, which is sufficient for initial survival needs while awaiting rescue.

Q15. How many survival craft walkie talkie required as per SOLAS for a ship of more than 500GT?

- A) 2
- B) 3
- C) 5
- D) 1

Correct Answer: A (2)

Explanation: SOLAS requires a minimum of three two-way VHF radiotelephone apparatus for ships of 500 GT and above to ensure communication between the survival craft and the rescuing vessel.

Q16. Quantity of water in Life raft per person:

- A) 1.5 Ltrs
- B) 2 Ltrs
- C) 3 Ltrs
- D) 2.5 Ltrs

Correct Answer: A (1.5 Ltrs)

Explanation: SOLAS standards for liferaft equipment specify a lower water requirement than for lifeboats, providing 1.5 liters of water per person.

Q17. What equipment is provided in Life raft to help you keep warm in cold weather?

- A) The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to give additional insulation from the cold
- B) The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to help insulation in addition to the TPA
- C) TPA for each person
- D) At least 10% or 2 TPA of the total crew

Correct Answer: B (The floor of the raft has a second layer which can be inflated to help insulation in addition to the TPA)



Q18. Which of the listed requirements do not corresponds to present regulation the life raft shall have:

- A) Manually controlled lamp visible of at least two miles fitted at the top of the canopy
- B) All entrances fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding the life raft
- C) Floor preventing the ingress of water
- D) Manually controlled lamp fitted inside the liferaft

Correct Answer: B (All entrances fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding the life raft)

Explanation: Rigid boarding ramps are not a universal requirement for all liferafts; however, they must be designed for safe entry, and internal/external lights are standard safety features.

Q19. In free fall Lifeboat, instead of Immersion suit TPA is provided for all persons:

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: In a free-fall lifeboat, immersion suits are mandatory to provide both buoyancy and thermal protection; TPA is not a substitute for an immersion suit in this scenario.

Q20. Your vessel have been in collision with another vessel, you are taking in water and you have to prepare for leaving the vessel. How will you act?

- A) Just jump overboard and be ready
- B) Collect your own personal belongings
- C) Assist your friends to collect their personal belonging
- D) Send a distress message and collect survival suits/Thermal bags

Correct Answer: D (Send a distress message and collect survival suits/Thermal bags)

Explanation: A professional response involves immediate communication of the distress to authorities, followed by orderly preparation using thermal protection and survival equipment.

Q21. Which one of the listed requirements regarding the stowage of a survival craft corresponds to present SOLAS regulations? Each survival craft shall be stowed:

- A) Wherever space is available
- B) In a state of readiness so that two crew members can prepare
- C) On the starboard side of the ship
- D) In a secure and sheltered position and protected from damage by fire and explosion

Correct Answer: B (In a state of readiness so that two crew members can prepare)

Explanation: SOLAS mandates that survival craft must be stowed in a state of readiness, so that two crew members can prepare them for launching within the prescribed time limits.

Q22. Which one of the listed requirements regarding LSA do not corresponds to present regulations?

- A) All prescribed LSA shall be made of non-combustible or fire retardant material
- B) All prescribed LSA shall be of a highly visible colour
- C) All prescribed LSA shall be fitted with a retro reflective material which will assist in detection
- D) All prescribed LSA shall be resistant to deterioration where exposed to sunlight

Correct Answer: A (All prescribed LSA shall be made of non-combustible or fire retardant material)

Explanation: LSA is generally required to be fire-resistant; however, the term 'non-combustible' is a strict standard that may not



~~Q23. Which one of the listed requirements regarding launching appliances for survival craft and rescue boat do not corresponds to present regulation?~~

- A) Parts requiring regular maintenance by ships crew shall be readily accessible
- B) The launching mechanism shall be arranged for actuating from a position within the survival craft or rescue boat in addition to a position on the ships deck
- C) All launching appliances shall be capable of recovering survival craft and rescue boats with their crew
- D) Launching appliances shall be constructed for minimum amount of routine maintainance

Correct Answer: C (All launching appliances shall be capable of recovering survival craft and rescue boats with their

Explanation: Launching appliances are generally designed for launching, not for recovery, with the specific exception of designated rescue boats which must be recoverable.

Q24. Maximum carrying capacity of a lifeboat:

- A) 100 Persons
- B) 150 Persons
- C) 50 Persons
- D) 25 Persons

Correct Answer: B (150 Persons)

Explanation: Under current SOLAS regulations, the maximum carrying capacity of a lifeboat is limited to 150 persons.

Q25. An Immersion suit shall permit the person wearing it:

- A) Climb up and down a vertical ladder of atleast 5m in length
- B) Perform normal duties associated with abandoning ship
- C) Jump from a height of not less than 4.5m
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Immersion suits must allow the user to perform all necessary abandon-ship tasks, including climbing ladders and jumping from specified heights without sustaining injury.

Q26. Checking and servicing life rafts as per PMS is:

- A) Once a year
- B) Twice a year
- C) Once in 5 years
- D) Based on condition of Liferaft

Correct Answer: A (Once a year)

Explanation: Liferrafts must be serviced at an approved shore-based facility every 12 months (annually) to ensure the inflation system and emergency pack remain in operational condition.

Q27. Before lifting a Lifeboat from water it should be ensured that:

- A) Bottom plug is secured tight
- B) Falls wires are clear and secured tightly
- C) Engine is going astern
- D) Sea anchor is streamed

Correct Answer: B (Falls wires are clear and secured tightly)



Q28. Which one of the routine test and inspection of LSA is not required by regulations:

- A) Lifeboat engine should be run for atleast 3 mins every week
- B) General emergency alarm to be tested daily
- C) Survival craft and Rescue boats with launching appliances shall be visually inspected weekly
- D) Inspection of Lifeboat equipments shall be carried out monthly

Correct Answer: B (General emergency alarm to be tested daily)

Explanation: The general emergency alarm is tested during fire and abandon ship drills, which are required to be held at least once a month, not daily. Other options represent standard weekly or monthly maintenance routines under SOLAS LSA Code requirements.

Q29. The function of hydrostatic release unit is:

- A) Substitute for limit switch of gravity davits
- B) To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks
- C) For releasing life raft in bad weather
- D) For releasing lifeboat from sinking vessel

Correct Answer: B (To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks)

Explanation: The hydrostatic release unit (HRU) is designed to operate automatically at a depth of 1.5 to 4 meters. When a vessel sinks, the pressure forces a piston to cut a weak link, allowing the liferaft to float free and inflate, thus preventing it from being pulled down by the sinking vessel.

Q30. Lifeboat should have:

- A) 2 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line
- B) 2 buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 15mtrs buoyant line
- C) 1 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line
- D) 1 buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 15mtrs buoyant line

Correct Answer: A (2 Buoyant rescue quoits, attached to not less than 30mtrs buoyant line)

Explanation: SOLAS Chapter III, LSA Code requires each lifeboat to be equipped with two buoyant rescue quoits, each attached to a buoyant line of not less than 30 meters in length. These are essential for recovering persons from the water.

Practice Set 3

Q1. The muster list shows who is the designated GMDSS operator. What do the letters GMDSS stand for?

- A) Global Marine Distress and Safety System
- B) General Maritime Distress and Safety System
- C) Global Maritime Distress and Safety System
- D) Global Maritime Distress and Security System

Correct Answer: C (Global Maritime Distress and Safety System)

Explanation: GMDSS stands for Global Maritime Distress and Safety System. It is an internationally agreed-upon set of safety procedures, types of equipment, and communication protocols used to increase safety and make it easier to rescue distressed ships, boats, and aircraft.



Q2. A mobile unit in distress should transmit the appropriate alarm signal followed by the distress call and message on one or all international distress frequencies. Which of the following sets of frequencies is correct?

- A) 500 kHz, 2182 kHz, and 156.8 MHz
- B) 400 kHz, 2182 kHz, and 121.5 MHz
- C) 500 kHz, 1642 kHz, and 156.8 MHz
- D) 600 kHz, 2182 kHz, and 156.5 MHz

Correct Answer: A (500 kHz, 2182 kHz, and 156.8 MHz)

Explanation: The frequency 500 kHz (radiotelegraphy), 2182 kHz (radiotelephony), and 156.8 MHz (VHF Channel 16) are the designated international distress and calling frequencies. While technology has shifted toward DSC, these remain the core frequencies for distress alerting.

Q3. Using spoken communication, what is the code word used to indicate a distress message?

- A) Pan Pan
- B) Securite
- C) Mayday
- D) Emergency

Correct Answer: C (Mayday)

Explanation: In GMDSS, 'Mayday' is the international radiotelephony distress signal. It is spoken three times to indicate a station is in grave and imminent danger and requires immediate assistance.

Q4. What action should the GMDSS operator take in a distress situation when embarking a survival craft?

- A) Keep EPIRB and SART switched off until a ship is seen
- B) Switch on EPIRB and SART immediately and leave them on
- C) Switch on only the EPIRB
- D) Leave them on board the main vessel

Correct Answer: B (Switch on EPIRB and SART immediately and leave them on)

Explanation: EPIRBs and SARTs are essential survival equipment. When abandoning ship, the GMDSS operator must ensure they are switched on and taken into the survival craft to provide continuous location data for search and rescue units.

Q5. What do the letters E.P.I.R.B. stand for?

- A) Emergency Position Indicating Radar Beacon
- B) Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon
- C) Electronic Position Indicating Radio Beacon
- D) Emergency Place Indicating Radio Beacon

Correct Answer: B (Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon)

Explanation: EPIRB stands for Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon. These devices are designed to transmit distress signals to satellites, providing the location of a vessel in distress to rescue authorities.

Q6. EPIRB alerting is a:

- A) Primary means of distress alerting
- B) Secondary means of distress alerting
- C) Tertiary means of distress alerting
- D) Non-essential means of distress alerting

Correct Answer: B (Secondary means of distress alerting)

Explanation: EPIRB alerting is considered a secondary means or a component of the alerting process. Primary alerting often involves GMDSS DSC equipment (VHF/MF/HF) which provides immediate notification to nearby vessels and shore stations.



- A) Inmarsat
- B) GPS / GLONASS
- C) COSPAS-SARSAT
- D) Iridium

Correct Answer: C (COSPAS-SARSAT)

Explanation: EPIRBs operate using the COSPAS-SARSAT satellite system. This international system detects and locates distress signals transmitted by radio beacons on 406 MHz.

Q8. LEOSAR stands for:

- A) Low Earth Orbiting Satellites for SAR
- B) Light Earth Orbiting Satellites for SAR
- C) Low Earth Orbiting Systems for Search and Rescue
- D) Long Earth Orbiting Satellites for SAR

Correct Answer: A (Low Earth Orbiting Satellites for SAR)

Explanation: LEOSAR stands for Low Earth Orbiting Search and Rescue. These satellites circle the earth in polar orbits, enabling the system to detect and locate beacons anywhere on the globe.

Q9. How many EPIRBs are carried on board a ship as per Solas regulations?

- A) Two
- B) Three
- C) One
- D) Four

Correct Answer: C (One)

Explanation: SOLAS regulations require all cargo ships and passenger ships on international voyages to carry at least one float-free satellite EPIRB, typically stored on the bridge or an easily accessible deck.

Q10. All self-propelled vessels on an international voyage must be equipped with how many emergency position indicating radio beacons?

- A) Two approved category 1 EPIRBs
- B) One approved category 1 EPIRB
- C) One category 2 EPIRB
- D) None

Correct Answer: B (One approved category 1 EPIRB)

Explanation: All self-propelled vessels on international voyages are required to carry one approved category 1 EPIRB, which is designed to float free from the ship and activate automatically if the vessel sinks.

Q11. Which position is shown by an EPIRB?

- A) Dead reckoning position
- B) Real time position
- C) Estimate position
- D) Estimated time of arrival

Correct Answer: B (Real time position)

Explanation: Modern EPIRBs (406 MHz) typically include an integrated GPS receiver, which provides the precise real-time position of the vessel in distress to the rescue coordination center.



- A) 121.5 MHz
- B) 243 MHz
- C) 406 MHz
- D) 156.8 MHz

Correct Answer: C (406 MHz)

Explanation: The 406 MHz frequency is the internationally designated frequency for satellite-based distress beacons under the COSPAS-SARSAT program, offering global coverage and improved location accuracy.

Q13. A VHF EPIRB is designed to be used in which GMDSS sea area?

- A) Area A2
- B) Area A3
- C) Area A1
- D) Area A4

Correct Answer: C (Area A1)

Explanation: VHF EPIRBs operate within the line-of-sight range, typically limited to the vessel's immediate vicinity or A1 sea areas, making them less versatile than satellite-based 406 MHz EPIRBs.

Q14. The battery used in EPIRBs, SARTs, and portable VHF radios is a:

- A) 12V Lead-acid battery
- B) 12V Primary lithium battery
- C) 6V Alkaline battery
- D) 12V Ni-Cad battery

Correct Answer: B (12V Primary lithium battery)

Explanation: Primary lithium batteries are used in GMDSS survival equipment because they provide a high energy density, long shelf life, and stable voltage output in extreme temperatures, which is essential for emergency gear.

Q15. The capacity of a lithium battery should be enough to last for how long when activated?

- A) 24 Hours
- B) 48 Hours
- C) 72 Hours
- D) 96 Hours

Correct Answer: B (48 Hours)

Explanation: SOLAS requires that survival craft batteries for GMDSS equipment (like portable VHF) must have sufficient capacity to operate for at least 48 hours to ensure communication during extended rescue operations.

Q16. The shelf life of a standard GMDSS survival craft battery is:

- A) 1 to 2 years
- B) 3 to 5 years
- C) 10 years
- D) 6 months

Correct Answer: B (3 to 5 years)

Explanation: Standard GMDSS survival craft batteries are designed to maintain their chemical integrity for 3 to 5 years. Regular replacement is required to ensure they meet operational standards during an actual emergency.



- A) 2 years
- B) 3 years
- C) 5 years or more
- D) 1 year

Correct Answer: C (5 years or more)

Explanation: EPIRB batteries are specialized high-capacity lithium units engineered for reliability. Their rigorous manufacturing and testing standards allow them to have a shelf life of 5 years or more.

Q18. Each EPIRB shall be tested using the integrated test circuit and output indicator every:

- A) Week
- B) Month
- C) Six months
- D) Year

Correct Answer: B (Month)

Explanation: To ensure functionality without exhausting the battery or causing false alerts, EPIRBs are tested monthly using their internal built-in test (BITE) circuit and an output indicator, as prescribed by maintenance schedules.

Q19. An EPIRB signal is designed to be received ultimately by the:

- A) RCC / MRCC (Maritime Rescue Coordination Center)
- B) Coast Guard station only
- C) Passing aircraft only
- D) Ship's agent

Correct Answer: A (RCC / MRCC (Maritime Rescue Coordination Center))

Explanation: The EPIRB signal is processed by the COSPAS-SARSAT system and routed to the nearest Maritime Rescue Coordination Center (MRCC), which coordinates the search and rescue efforts.

Q20. The time delay in detection and relaying of an EPIRB transmission in global mode can be up to:

- A) 30 minutes
- B) 1 hour
- C) 2 hours
- D) 4 hours

Correct Answer: C (2 hours)

Explanation: While satellite processing is fast, the orbit of polar-orbiting satellites can result in a time delay. Under optimal conditions, this can be up to 2 hours before the signal is relayed to an MRCC.

Q21. Your Master ensures that the EPIRB is:

- A) Tested weekly
- B) Tested monthly
- C) Tested yearly
- D) Serviced every 6 months

Correct Answer: B (Tested monthly)

Explanation: The Master ensures compliance with maintenance requirements by scheduling the monthly internal self-test of the EPIRB, which verifies that the battery, circuitry, and transmitter are operational.



- A) Hydrostatic Release Unit
- B) Hydraulic Release Unit
- C) High Rescue Unit
- D) Hydrostatic Rescue Utility

Correct Answer: A (Hydrostatic Release Unit)

Explanation: HRU stands for Hydrostatic Release Unit, a device designed to release liferafts and EPIRBs automatically when a ship sinks to a specific depth, usually between 1.5 and 4 meters.

Q23. SART stands for:

- A) Search and Rescue Radar Transmitter
- B) Search and Rescue Radar Transponder
- C) Shipping and Rescue Tracking
- D) Search and Recovery Transponder

Correct Answer: B (Search and Rescue Radar Transponder)

Explanation: SART stands for Search and Rescue Radar Transponder. It is a portable device used in survival craft to indicate their location on a ship's radar screen.

Q24. What does the standard IMO symbol with concentric circles and a mini radar indicator mean?

- A) EPIRB
- B) Two-way VHF
- C) SART
- D) Radar reflector

Correct Answer: C (SART)

Explanation: The IMO symbol with concentric circles and a mini radar indicator is the international identifier for a SART, marking its location so survivors can easily find it during an emergency.

Q25. How can a SART's detection range be increased?

- A) By placing it inside the water
- B) It should be held as high as possible
- C) By turning it off horizontally
- D) By wrapping it in cloth

Correct Answer: B (It should be held as high as possible)

Explanation: A SART's detection range is limited by the curvature of the earth and the height of the radar antenna. Holding the SART as high as possible increases the line-of-sight range for searching vessels or aircraft.

Q26. In the search and rescue radar transponder (SART), how is this device activated?

- A) Automatically when submerged
- B) It is carried into the survival craft and switched on by the occupants
- C) Remotely from the bridge
- D) Via satellite signal

Correct Answer: B (It is carried into the survival craft and switched on by the occupants)

Explanation: A SART is a portable device that must be manually removed from its stowage by crew members when abandoning ship and activated by the occupants in the survival craft.



- A) 24 hours
- B) 48 hours
- C) 96 hours
- D) 5 days

Correct Answer: C (96 hours)

Explanation: A SART must have enough battery capacity to operate in standby mode for 96 hours, ensuring it remains ready to respond to interrogating radar signals for the duration of a search.

Q28. A SART works on which radar frequency band?

- A) S-band
- B) X-band
- C) C-band
- D) Ka-band

Correct Answer: B (X-band)

Explanation: SARTs operate on the X-band (9 GHz) frequency, as this is the standard frequency used by marine radar systems to detect navigation hazards and objects like lifeboats.

Q29. What is the precise frequency and wavelength at which a SART operates?

- A) 3 GHz, 10 cm (S-band)
- B) 9 GHz, 3 cm (X-band)
- C) 156.8 MHz
- D) 406 MHz

Correct Answer: B (9 GHz, 3 cm (X-band))

Explanation: SARTs operate at the 9 GHz frequency, which corresponds to a wavelength of approximately 3 cm. This matches the standard marine navigation radar, allowing the SART to appear as a series of dots on the radar screen.

Q30. How many radar transponders (SARTs) are required to be carried on board ships for use in survival crafts?

- A) One only
- B) Two (or one on each side of the ship)
- C) Three
- D) Four

Correct Answer: B (Two (or one on each side of the ship))

Explanation: SOLAS requirements state that ships must carry at least two SARTs (or one on each side) to ensure reliable detection from any direction and redundancy in case one device fails.

Practice Set 4



- A) Pyrotechnics
- B) Open fire
- C) Flag NC
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: All listed items-pyrotechnics (flares), fire (on deck), and the display of international code flags (like flag NC)-are recognized international distress signals under COLREGs and other maritime safety protocols.

Q2. Your vessel has been in a collision with another vessel. You are taking in water and you have to prepare for leaving the vessel. How will you act?

- A) Immediately jump overboard
- B) Send a distress message and collect survival suits and thermal bags
- C) Wait on deck without any equipment
- D) Drop anchor and hide in your cabin

Correct Answer: B (Send a distress message and collect survival suits and thermal bags)

Explanation: Upon collision, the priority is to communicate the situation to ensure rescue can be initiated. Gathering survival suits and thermal protection is vital for maintaining body temperature in case abandonment becomes necessary.

Q3. Your vessel has been in a collision and you are not sure if your vessel is sinking or not. How will you handle this situation?

- A) Order immediate abandonment without checking
- B) Search for missing persons, continue to monitor the situation, and prepare for abandonment in case it becomes necessary
- C) Disregard the collision and continue steaming
- D) Turn off all alarms to prevent panic

Correct Answer: B (Search for missing persons, continue to monitor the situation, and prepare for abandonment in case it becomes necessary)

Explanation: Immediate, uncoordinated abandonment is dangerous. The crew must search for casualties and monitor vessel stability to make an informed decision, ensuring the ship is truly beyond saving before departing.

Q4. An alarm signal consisting of seven short blasts followed by one prolonged blast is sounded by the ship's whistle and alarm bells. What are you to do?

- A) Go to the galley for food
- B) Go to your lifeboat/muster station
- C) Proceed to the engine room workshop
- D) Remain in your bunk

Correct Answer: B (Go to your lifeboat/muster station)

Explanation: The signal of seven or more short blasts followed by one prolonged blast on the whistle and alarm bells is the mandatory general emergency alarm, requiring all crew to report to their assigned muster stations.

Personal Survival Techniques (PST) Exit Exam Prep
Q5. Your vessel is a tanker in ballast and the two vessels are interlocked after a collision. After ensuring people are well taken care of, you try to separate the two vessels. What should be your greatest concern?



- A) Losing your anchor
- B) That the separation may cause sparks that can possibly ignite the oil or any other flammable substances
- C) Damaging the ship's paint
- D) Missing the next port schedule

Correct Answer: B (That the separation may cause sparks that can possibly ignite the oil or any other flammable substances)

Explanation: When separating vessels, friction can generate sparks or heat. On a tanker, this poses an extreme risk of igniting flammable vapors, which could lead to an explosion or fire, making safety precautions paramount.

Q6. Which one of the given requirements regarding the manning and supervision of survival craft corresponds to Solas regulations?

- A) Any crew member can command a survival craft
- B) A deck officer or certificated person shall be placed in charge of each survival craft to be used
- C) Only the Chief Cook can manage survival craft
- D) Lifeboats don't require any assigned person-in-charge

Correct Answer: B (A deck officer or certificated person shall be placed in charge of each survival craft to be used)

Explanation: SOLAS Chapter III stipulates that for every survival craft, a certificated person or deck officer must be placed in charge to ensure orderly launching, navigation, and coordination of the survivors.

Q7. Where do you find the minimum drill requirements for merchant vessels?

- A) In the MARPOL convention
- B) In the STCW convention
- C) In the Solas convention
- D) In the ISPS code

Correct Answer: C (In the Solas convention)

Explanation: SOLAS (International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea) mandates minimum requirements for safety drills, including lifeboat, fire, and abandonment drills, to ensure crew readiness.

Q8. What is most important when preparing for shipboard emergencies?

- A) Having the best food on board
- B) That people are well trained
- C) Having a high speed engine
- D) Having a clean uniform

Correct Answer: B (That people are well trained)

Explanation: The effectiveness of emergency response is entirely dependent on the proficiency and training of the crew. Well-trained personnel can react calmly and execute complex procedures even under high-stress conditions.

Q9. When should abandonment of a ship be undertaken?

- A) As soon as a minor fire starts
- B) As a last resort on orders from the Master
- C) When the ship runs out of fresh water
- D) At any time individual crew members feel like it

Correct Answer: B (As a last resort on orders from the Master)

Explanation: Abandonment is a critical, life-threatening procedure. It must only be done as a last resort, after the Master has



~~Q10. Posters or signs shall be provided on or in the vicinity of survival craft and their launching controls. Which~~
of the following details does NOT explicitly need to be displayed according to this specific regulation?

- A) Illustrate the purpose of controls and procedures for launching
- B) Give recommendations for survival
- C) Give information on survival craft capacity
- D) Give warning notices

Correct Answer: C (Give information on survival craft capacity)

Explanation: While capacity is vital, the specific regulation regarding posters in the vicinity of launching controls focuses on operational instructions, safety warnings, and survival recommendations, rather than the specific capacity of the craft.

Q11. In an emergency situation, is it a good idea to jump overboard and swim towards a launched lifeboat?

- A) Yes, it is the quickest option
- B) As a general rule, don't jump into the sea
- C) Yes, always jump with your shoes off
- D) Jump only if the water is warm

Correct Answer: B (As a general rule, don't jump into the sea)

Explanation: Jumping into the sea poses risks of injury, hypothermia, and separation. The general rule is to enter the water carefully and only when necessary, as abandoning the vessel via controlled launching is always preferred.

Q12. What is the working duration of a Man Overboard (MOB) smoke float?

- A) 5 minutes
- B) 10 minutes
- C) 15 minutes
- D) 30 minutes

Correct Answer: C (15 minutes)

Explanation: MOB smoke floats, attached to lifebuoys, are designed to produce dense orange smoke for at least 15 minutes to provide a visual marker for locating a person in the water.

Q13. Lifeboats can be safely lowered using painters when the vessel is making headway up to a speed of:

- A) 2 knots
- B) 5 knots
- C) 10 knots
- D) 12 knots

Correct Answer: B (5 knots)

Explanation: Modern lifeboats are designed for launching while a ship has headway. Regulations and testing ensure they can be safely launched using painters at a speed of up to 5 knots in calm water.

Q14. How much water is provided in a standard life raft per person?

- A) 1 liter
- B) 1.5 liters
- C) 3 liters
- D) 0.5 liters

Correct Answer: B (1.5 liters)

Explanation: To ensure survival during the critical first days after abandonment, SOLAS requires that 1.5 liters of fresh water be



~~Q15. What is the minimum number of lifebuoys required on a cargo ship of length over 200 meters?~~

- A) 8
- B) 10
- C) 12
- D) 14

Correct Answer: D (14)

Explanation: For a vessel over 200 meters, the number of lifebuoys required by SOLAS is 14. This quantity is mandated to ensure rapid accessibility from any point on the deck during an emergency.

Q16. What is the percentage requirement for child life jackets on a cargo vessel?

- A) 5 percent
- B) 10 percent
- C) 15 percent
- D) 20 percent

Correct Answer: B (10 percent)

Explanation: SOLAS requires that vessels carry lifejackets for all persons on board, plus an additional 10% for children, to ensure there are correctly sized life-saving appliances for all passengers and crew.

Q17. Once you hear the fire alarm, where must you proceed?

- A) To the bridge
- B) To your cabin to sleep
- C) Proceed to your designated muster station
- D) To the lifeboats directly

Correct Answer: C (Proceed to your designated muster station)

Explanation: Upon hearing the fire alarm or general emergency alarm, all crew must proceed immediately to their designated muster station as specified in the Muster List. This ensures accountability and allows for the orderly execution of emergency procedures.

Q18. What is the regulatory donning time allowed for an immersion suit?

- A) 1 minute
- B) 2 minutes
- C) 3 minutes
- D) 5 minutes

Correct Answer: B (2 minutes)

Explanation: According to the LSA Code, an immersion suit must be designed to be donned within a period of 2 minutes, excluding the removal of any clothing, ensuring rapid response in survival situations.

Q19. When a group of persons is floating in cold water without a craft, they should form which protective position?

- A) Single line position
- B) Horizontal starfish position
- C) Huddle position
- D) Swimming in circles

Correct Answer: C (Huddle position)



Q20. Which one of the listed requirements regarding rigid life rafts does NOT correspond to present regulations?

- A) It shall be fitted with an efficient painter
- B) The floor shall prevent the ingress of water
- C) All the entrances must be fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding life rafts at sea
- D) It must be highly visible

Correct Answer: C (All the entrances must be fitted with rigid boarding ramps for boarding life rafts at sea)

Explanation: While life rafts are equipped with boarding ladders or means to assist access, rigid boarding ramps are not a universal requirement for all life rafts, making option C the incorrect regulatory statement.

Q21. Checking and servicing life rafts as per the Planned Maintenance System (PMS) is carried out:

- A) Once every 6 months
- B) Once a year (Every 12 months)
- C) Every 2 years
- D) Monthly

Correct Answer: B (Once a year (Every 12 months))

Explanation: SOLAS regulations require that life rafts must be serviced at an approved shore-based facility at intervals not exceeding 12 months to ensure the integrity of the raft, inflation system, and emergency packs.

Q22. Before lifting a lifeboat from the water back to its davits, it must be ensured that:

- A) The engine is still running at full speed
- B) Falls are clear and secured tightly (hooked securely)
- C) All gear is thrown overboard
- D) The drain plug is wide open

Correct Answer: B (Falls are clear and secured tightly (hooked securely))

Explanation: For the safe recovery of a lifeboat, it is critical to ensure that the falls are properly secured to the hooks and the release gear is in the correct position to prevent accidental disengagement during hoisting.

Q23. Which one of the listed routine tests and inspections of LSA is NOT required on a daily/weekly basis by present regulations?

- A) Lifeboat engine test weekly
- B) Inspection of lifeboats weekly
- C) General emergency alarm to be tested daily
- D) Testing of life jacket lights

Correct Answer: C (General emergency alarm to be tested daily)

Explanation: The General Emergency Alarm is required to be tested periodically (e.g., weekly), but there is no regulatory requirement for it to be tested on a daily basis.



- A) One rescue quoit with a 10-meter line
- B) Two buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 30 meters of buoyant line
- C) No rescue lines attached
- D) Wire lines instead of ropes

Correct Answer: B (Two buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than 30 meters of buoyant line)

Explanation: The LSA Code stipulates that every lifeboat must carry two buoyant rescue quoits, each attached to a buoyant line of at least 30 meters, to facilitate the rescue of a person in the water.

Q25. In a free-fall lifeboat, instead of immersion suits, TPAs (Thermal Protective Aids) are provided to all persons.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: Immersion suits are mandatory for all persons on board, including those in free-fall lifeboats, unless the vessel operates in warm climates where they may be exempt; they are not replaced by TPAs.

Q26. The luminous intensity of a hand flare should not be less than:

- A) 5,000 cd
- B) 10,000 cd
- C) 15,000 cd
- D) 20,000 cd

Correct Answer: C (15,000 cd)

Explanation: The LSA Code mandates that hand flares must have a luminous intensity of not less than 15,000 candela to ensure visibility during distress signaling.

Q27. Hand flares burn with a bright red color.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: A (True)

Explanation: Distress signals, specifically hand flares, are designed to burn with a bright red color to provide a high-contrast visual signal against the natural environment, ensuring they are easily recognized as a distress call.

Q28. A Line Throwing Apparatus (LTA) is fundamentally used to pass a:

- A) Heavy mooring wire
- B) Messenger line
- C) Fuel hose line
- D) Anchor chain

Correct Answer: B (Messenger line)

Explanation: The Line Throwing Apparatus is a pyrotechnic device designed to fire a projectile carrying a thin 'messenger line' from one ship to another or to shore, which is then used to pull over heavier tow lines or moorings.

Q29. A life jacket light shall have a source of energy capable of providing a luminous intensity of _____ period of _____:



- A) 0.5 cd / 4 hours
- B) 0.75 cd / 8 hours
- C) 1.5 cd / 2 hours
- D) 10 cd / 12 hours

Correct Answer: B (0.75 cd / 8 hours)

Explanation: Read as 0.75 cd in standard LSA code

Q30. Lifeboats must be stored in such a way on a cargo ship that they can be fully launched within a maximum of:

- A) 5 minutes
- B) 10 minutes
- C) 15 minutes
- D) 30 minutes

Correct Answer: B (10 minutes)

Explanation: SOLAS regulations require that cargo ships be fitted with survival craft that can be boarded and launched within a maximum period of 10 minutes to ensure quick evacuation.

Practice Set 5

Q1. Where are additional life jackets kept on board a vessel?

- A) Hidden inside cabins
- B) In conspicuous, clearly marked places on deck or at muster stations
- C) Locked inside the steering gear room
- D) In the paint locker

Correct Answer: B (In conspicuous, clearly marked places on deck or at muster stations)

Explanation: Life jackets must be stowed in conspicuous and clearly marked places, such as near cabin entrances or at muster stations, to ensure they are immediately accessible during an emergency.

Q2. Which of the listed requirements regarding the storage of lifeboats and life rafts does NOT correspond to present Solas regulations?

- A) Life rafts intended for throw-overboard launching shall be stored amidships secured to means for transfer to either side
- B) They must be stored in a state of continuous readiness
- C) They must not interfere with other survival craft
- D) They must be safely secured

Correct Answer: A (Life rafts intended for throw-overboard launching shall be stored amidships secured to means for transfer to either side)

Explanation: Life rafts intended for throw-overboard launching do not need to be stored amidships; they are typically stored near the ship's side to facilitate a quick, direct drop into the water.



- A) 6 lifebuoys
- B) 8 lifebuoys
- C) 10 lifebuoys
- D) 12 lifebuoys

Correct Answer: C (10 lifebuoys)

Explanation: According to the LSA Code, for vessels of 100 meters and over in length, a minimum of 10 lifebuoys is required to be distributed along the sides of the ship.

Q4. The function of a hydrostatic release unit (HRU) is:

- A) To launch the lifeboat manually
- B) To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks
- C) To measure the depth of the sea
- D) To pump water out of the life raft

Correct Answer: B (To automatically unhook the lashing and release the life raft when the ship sinks)

Explanation: A Hydrostatic Release Unit (HRU) is a pressure-sensitive device that automatically releases the life raft's lashing when submerged to a depth of 1.5 to 4 meters, allowing the raft to float free as the ship sinks.

Q5. What are the characteristics of Carbon Dioxide (CO₂)?

- A) It is lighter than oxygen
- B) It is heavier than oxygen
- C) It supports combustion
- D) It is bright green in color

Correct Answer: B (It is heavier than oxygen)

Explanation: Carbon dioxide (CO₂) is a colorless, odorless gas that is heavier than air (and oxygen). It suppresses fire by displacing oxygen in the environment, effectively smothering the fire.

Q6. Which one of the listed requirements regarding buoyant smoke signals does NOT correspond to present regulations? The buoyant smoke signal shall:

- A) Emit smoke of a highly visible color
- B) Give a bright red light during the entire emission time
- C) Not ignite explosively
- D) Continue to emit smoke when submerged in water

Correct Answer: B (Give a bright red light during the entire emission time)

Explanation: Smoke signals emit smoke, not a bright light

Q7. Which one of the listed requirements regarding the launching and recovery arrangements for survival craft corresponds to present Solas regulations?

- A) The operator on deck cannot see the craft during lowering
- B) Launching and recovery arrangements shall be such that the operator at all times observes the survival craft and lifeboats
- C) Only manual hand-crank can be used for lowering
- D) Launching must take at least 1 hour

Correct Answer: B (Launching and recovery arrangements shall be such that the operator at all times observes the survival craft and lifeboats)

Explanation: Launching and recovery systems must be designed so that the operator in charge of the launching procedure has a



Q8. Which one of the listed requirements regarding a lifeboat's propulsion system does NOT correspond to present regulations?

- A) The engine must be an internal combustion engine
- B) The engine shall be provided with an electric power starting system with rechargeable energy batteries only
- C) The engine must run on fuel with a flashpoint of 43 degreesC or less
- D) The engine must be capable of starting at 15 degreesC below zero

Correct Answer: B (The engine shall be provided with an electric power starting system with rechargeable energy batteries only)

Explanation: Lifeboats must have secondary manual/hydraulic starting mechanisms

Q9. Which one of the listed requirements regarding abandon ship and fire drills does NOT correspond to present regulations?

- A) Every crew member must participate monthly
- B) On all short international voyages, muster of passengers shall take place as soon as possible after departure
- C) Passengers must be trained to launch lifeboats
- D) Drills must be recorded in the logbook

Correct Answer: B (On all short international voyages, muster of passengers shall take place as soon as possible after departure)

Explanation: For short voyages, it should be before or immediately at departure

Q10. After the first 24 hours in a life raft, how much water is allocated per person per day?

- A) 1 Liter
- B) 0.5 Liter (half liter)
- C) 1.5 Liters
- D) 2 Liters

Correct Answer: B (0.5 Liter (half liter))

Explanation: To preserve physiological function in a survival situation, the intake of water is restricted. For the first 24 hours, no water is consumed, followed by a ration of 0.5 liters per person per day.

Q11. Which of the following items shall be included in each fire drill?

- A) Painting the fire hydrants
- B) Checking the operation of watertight doors, fire doors, fire dampers, and relevant communication equipment
- C) Emptying all fuel tanks
- D) Dismantling the main fire pump

Correct Answer: B (Checking the operation of watertight doors, fire doors, fire dampers, and relevant communication equipment)

Explanation: Fire drills must be realistic and include the operation of fire pumps, communication equipment, and the closing of fire-resisting doors and dampers to ensure all crew are familiar with fire-fighting systems.

Q12. How should the painter of a life raft fitted with a hydrostatic release unit be secured to the ship?

- A) Shackled directly to a heavy structural frame
- B) Secured via a weak link to a secure point on the ship
- C) Left loose on the deck
- D) Tied to the railing with a simple knot

Correct Answer: B (Secured via a weak link to a secure point on the ship)

Explanation: The painter is attached to the ship via a 'weak link' so that if the ship sinks, the hydrostatic release unit activates, the



Q13. Which one of the listed requirements regarding partially enclosed lifeboats does NOT correspond to present regulations? The canopy between rigid covers shall be:

- A) Easily erectable
- B) Insulated against cold and heat
- C) It has windows to admit sufficient daylight inside the boat with the canopy closed
- D) Completely opaque with no light entering

Correct Answer: C (It has windows to admit sufficient daylight inside the boat with the canopy closed)

Explanation: Partially enclosed lifeboats must have a canopy that provides protection but also includes windows to allow daylight to enter, ensuring the interior is not completely dark for the occupants.

Q14. Which of the following is considered a general emergency on board a ship?

- A) Hull failure
- B) Uncontrolled venting or cargo jettisoning on a gas tanker
- C) Loss of stability during cargo operations
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: A general emergency refers to any catastrophic event that threatens the safety of the ship or personnel, including hull failure, uncontrolled cargo incidents, or stability loss, requiring immediate muster.

Q15. Which one of the listed requirements regarding the stability of inflatable life rafts does NOT correspond to present regulations? The stability of inflatable life rafts shall be such that:

- A) It can withstand high winds
- B) In the event of capsizing, it will automatically attain a position providing an enable water escape
- C) It has water pockets underneath
- D) It can be towed easily

Correct Answer: B (In the event of capsizing, it will automatically attain a position providing an enable water escape)

Explanation: Inflatable life rafts don't automatically self-right unless they are specially designed self-righting types

Q16. Retro-reflective tape is provided on which equipment?

- A) Anchor chains and windlass
- B) Lifeboats and life rafts
- C) Fire hoses and nozzles
- D) Main engine control panel

Correct Answer: B (Lifeboats and life rafts)

Explanation: Retro-reflective tape is required on all LSA, including lifeboats, life rafts, and life jackets, to make them visible at night by reflecting light from searchlights or other sources.

Q17. How much lifeboat capacity should be provided on a conventional cargo ship of more than 85 meters in length?

- A) 50% on each side
- B) 100% of the ship's complement on each side
- C) 150% total capacity anywhere
- D) 200% on each side



Correct Answer: B (100% of the ship's complement on each side)

Explanation: For cargo ships of 85 meters and above, SOLAS requires that lifeboats be carried on each side of the ship with a total capacity of 100% of the ship's complement on each side.

Q18. Which one of the listed requirements regarding rescue boat equipment does NOT correspond to present regulations? The normal equipment of every rescue boat shall include:

- A) Buoyant oars or paddlers
- B) A buoyant biler
- C) Immersion suits for the total number of persons the boat is permitted to accommodate
- D) A searchlight

Correct Answer: C (Immersion suits for the total number of persons the boat is permitted to accommodate)

Explanation: Regulations only specify them for the actual rescue boat crew, not full capacity

Q19. A SART typically uses a lithium primary battery of:

- A) 6 Volts
- B) 12 Volts
- C) 24 Volts
- D) 1.5 Volts

Correct Answer: B (12 Volts)

Explanation: The SART is a survival craft transponder that, as per IMO performance standards, typically utilizes a 12-volt battery to provide sufficient power for its 96-hour standby and 8-hour transmission requirement.

Q20. What is the minimum number of channels required for a portable 2-way VHF radio used for survival craft?

- A) Channel 12 only
- B) Channel 16
- C) Channels 6, 13, and 16
- D) Channel 70

Correct Answer: B (Channel 16)

Explanation: A portable two-way VHF radio for survival craft must be capable of operating on Channel 16, which is the international distress, safety, and calling channel.

Q21. Which channel is designated as the VHF follow-on communication channel and is mandatory in all portable survival craft equipment?

- A) Channel 6
- B) Channel 13
- C) Channel 16
- D) Channel 22

Correct Answer: C (Channel 16)

Explanation: Channel 16 is the mandatory calling and distress frequency. Once contact is established on Channel 16, the survival craft and rescuers switch to a 'follow-on' channel to keep the distress frequency clear.



- A) 2 sets for all ships built after 2000
- B) 3 sets; new builds from February 1992, other ships from February 1995
- C) 5 sets for any container ship
- D) 1 set per lifeboat station

Correct Answer: B (3 sets; new builds from February 1992, other ships from February 1995)

Explanation: GMDSS requirements dictate that cargo vessels must carry at least 3 sets of two-way VHF radiotelephone apparatuses for use in survival craft to ensure effective communication during abandonment.

Q23. Batteries fitted in an EPIRB, SART, etc., are to be changed when:

- A) They look old and dusty
- B) Battery to be changed as per the expiry date mentioned by the maker
- C) Every 6 months automatically
- D) Only after they drain out completely during an emergency

Correct Answer: B (Battery to be changed as per the expiry date mentioned by the maker)

Explanation: Batteries for safety equipment like SARTs and EPIRBs have a limited service life due to chemical degradation. They must be replaced by the manufacturer's specified expiry date to ensure reliability.

Q24. If a distress signal is received on board, what should you do?

- A) Contact SAR authorities via the nearest coastal radio station
- B) Post an extra lookout
- C) Try to make contact with the vessel in distress
- D) All of the alternatives together

Correct Answer: D (All of the alternatives together)

Explanation: Upon receiving a distress signal, a vessel is under legal and moral obligation to assist, which involves notifying SAR authorities, maintaining a sharp lookout, and attempting to establish communication.

Q25. What is the minimum required duration of a buoyant smoke marker?

- A) 1 minute
- B) 2 minutes
- C) 3 minutes
- D) 5 minutes

Correct Answer: C (3 minutes)

Explanation: A buoyant smoke marker is a distress signal that must produce smoke for a duration of at least 3 minutes to provide a sustained visual reference for search and rescue aircraft or vessels.

Q26. Life jackets should be stored in:

- A) Sealed boxes requiring tools to open
- B) Readily accessible spaces
- C) The steering flat
- D) Under lock and key by the Chief Mate

Correct Answer: B (Readily accessible spaces)

Explanation: Life jackets must be stored in readily accessible spaces so that they can be retrieved quickly without hindrance, even in the dark or during vessel movement.

Personal Survival Techniques (PST) Exit Exam Prep
Q27. Which one of the listed requirements regarding lifeboat fittings does NOT correspond to present regulations? All lifeboats shall be fitted with:



- A) An efficient drain valve
- B) A rudder and tiller
- C) A continuous bright flame burning bucket around the outside of the lifeboat
- D) Lifelines becketed around the outside

Correct Answer: C (A continuous bright flame burning bucket around the outside of the lifeboat)

Explanation: Lifeboats are not required to be fitted with a burning bucket around the outside; such a device would be hazardous and inefficient. The other options listed are standard mandatory requirements.

Q28. Lifeboats should have:

- A) Wire lines instead of lifelines
- B) Two buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than a 30-meter buoyant line
- C) A 100-meter nylon hawser
- D) No lines for throwing

Correct Answer: B (Two buoyant rescue quoits attached to not less than a 30-meter buoyant line)

Explanation: Lifeboats must carry two buoyant rescue quoits attached to at least 30 meters of buoyant line to allow for the recovery of persons from the water.

Q29. Every lifeboat is required to be launched and maneuvered in water at least once in every:

- A) Month
- B) Two months
- C) Three months
- D) Year

Correct Answer: C (Three months)

Explanation: SOLAS requires that each survival craft must be stowed, launched, and maneuvered in the water at intervals of at least once every three months during a drill.

Q30. After abandoning ship, survivors in a lifeboat must be given:

- A) Rations and water immediately
- B) No water for the first 24 hours
- C) Double rations of water if they feel hot
- D) Seawater to drink

Correct Answer: B (No water for the first 24 hours)

Explanation: To avoid dehydration induced by the body attempting to process the salt content of seawater, survivors are instructed not to drink water for the first 24 hours to stabilize their fluid balance.

Practice Set 6

Q1. Fire-protected lifeboats, when waterborne, should be capable of protecting their full complement, when subjected to a continuous oil fire that envelops the boat for a period of not less than:



- A) 5 minutes
- B) 8 minutes
- C) 15 minutes
- D) 20 minutes

Correct Answer: B (8 minutes)

Explanation: Fire-protected lifeboats (tanker lifeboats) are specifically designed to withstand extreme heat and must be capable of surviving for at least 8 minutes in a continuous oil fire.

Q2. An enclosed lifeboat is fitted with a self-contained air support system. With the engine running, what is the minimum period of time the air should remain safe and breathable?

- A) 5 minutes
- B) 10 minutes
- C) 20 minutes
- D) 30 minutes

Correct Answer: B (10 minutes)

Explanation: Enclosed lifeboats must have a self-contained air support system capable of providing breathable air for at least 10 minutes, protecting occupants from toxic smoke or fumes during launching.

Q3. The smoke detector panel indicates a fire in a cargo hold loaded with general cargo. What first action should be taken?

- A) Open all hatches to look inside
- B) Run fire hoses into the hold immediately
- C) Close the ventilation system and other openings to the hold in order to choke the fire
- D) Increase the mechanical ventilation speed

Correct Answer: C (Close the ventilation system and other openings to the hold in order to choke the fire)

Explanation: In the event of a fire in a cargo hold, the immediate first step is to cut off the oxygen supply by closing all ventilation dampers and sealing the compartment to starve the fire.

Q4. Lifebuoy self-igniting lights shall be capable of burning continuously for a period of not less than:

- A) 1 hour
- B) 2 hours
- C) 4 hours
- D) 8 hours

Correct Answer: B (2 hours)

Explanation: Lifebuoy self-igniting lights must be able to operate continuously for at least 2 hours to provide a visual marker in the water for search and rescue teams.

Q5. Lifeboats on cargo vessels must be stored in such a way that they can be fully boarded and launched within a maximum of:

- A) 5 minutes
- B) 10 minutes
- C) 20 minutes
- D) 30 minutes



Correct Answer: B (10 minutes)
 Explanation: For cargo vessels, the storage of lifeboats must permit them to be fully boarded and launched within a maximum time of 10 minutes to minimize risk during an emergency.

Q6. The centrifugal brake mechanism incorporated in a lifeboat handling winch is intended to:

- A) Stop the boat instantly if a cable snaps
- B) Automatically control the speed of lowering by gravity
- C) Increase the lifting speed of the winch motor
- D) Lock the davit arms in the stowed position

Correct Answer: B (Automatically control the speed of lowering by gravity)

Explanation: The centrifugal brake is a safety feature on the lifeboat winch that automatically regulates the lowering speed by gravity, preventing the boat from descending too fast.

Q7. If the water is rising in the bilge of a survival craft, you should first:

- A) Abandon the survival craft
- B) Check the bilge drain plug
- C) Start drilling holes to let water out
- D) Use a hand flare to signal for help

Correct Answer: B (Check the bilge drain plug)

Explanation: A rising water level in the bilge indicates either a leak or an improperly secured drain plug; therefore, the plug must be the first item checked to prevent flooding.

Q8. The maximum speed of lowering for a lifeboat on gravity davits is controlled by the:

- A) Limit switch
- B) Governor brake
- C) Electric winch motor
- D) Hand crank handle

Correct Answer: B (Governor brake)

Explanation: The governor brake (or centrifugal brake) is the primary mechanism that limits the speed of the lifeboat during gravity lowering to a safe rate of descent.

Q9. The function of the lifeboat davit limit switch is to:

- A) Stop the boat from lowering too fast into the water
- B) Cut off power to the winch when the lifeboat nears the final stowed position
- C) Release the hooks automatically
- D) Turn on the lifeboat internal lights

Correct Answer: B (Cut off power to the winch when the lifeboat nears the final stowed position)

Explanation: The limit switch is a safety device that cuts off the power to the winch motor when the lifeboat reaches the final stowed position, preventing damage to the davits.

Q10. Most lifeboats are equipped with which type of rudder configuration?

- A) Balanced rudder
- B) Unbalanced rudder
- C) Flap rudder
- D) Semi-balanced rudder

Correct Answer: B (Unbalanced rudder)



Q11. At what speed and for how long must a fully loaded motor lifeboat operate in calm water?

- A) 4 knots for 12 hours
- B) 6 knots for 24 hours
- C) 10 knots for 48 hours
- D) 5 knots for 6 hours

Correct Answer: B (6 knots for 24 hours)

Explanation: A fully loaded motor lifeboat is required to have an engine capable of propelling the boat at a speed of at least 6 knots in calm water for a period of 24 hours.

Q12. In a free-fall lifeboat, instead of immersion suits, TPAs (Thermal Protective Aids) are provided to all persons on board.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: TPAs are designed to reduce heat loss, but they do not replace immersion suits, which provide both buoyancy and thermal protection for all crew members on board.

Q13. Which item in the lifeboat is considered a regulatory study/instructional material?

- A) Engineering blue print of the ship
- B) Instructions on how to survive on board the craft
- C) Nautical almanac
- D) Solas Consolidated Edition

Correct Answer: B (Instructions on how to survive on board the craft)

Explanation: LSA Code regulations mandate that survival craft must carry manuals or instructions detailing survival techniques and the operation of craft equipment to assist survivors in maintaining their safety and welfare after abandoning ship.

Q14. What is the standard minimum length of a lifeboat painter?

- A) 10 meters
- B) 15 meters
- C) 30 meters
- D) 50 meters

Correct Answer: B (15 meters)

Explanation: Under the International Life-Saving Appliance (LSA) Code, the lifeboat painter must have a length of at least 15 meters to ensure safe tethering and deployment during launching operations.

Q15. What is the purpose of the hydrostatic interlock in the keel of an enclosed lifeboat?

- A) It prevents the engine from starting out of the water
- B) It prevents release of the hooks until the keel of the boat is fully under water
- C) It automatically pumps out the bilges
- D) It stabilizes the boat's rolling

Correct Answer: B (It prevents release of the hooks until the keel of the boat is fully under water)

Explanation: The hydrostatic interlock is a critical safety mechanism designed to prevent the accidental release of lifeboat hooks while the craft is still suspended in the davits; it only allows release once the buoyancy of the water triggers the mechanism.



- A) Go faster
- B) Capsize
- C) Pitch heavily
- D) Align smoothly

Correct Answer: B (Capsize)

Explanation: Steering broadside to heavy seas exposes the lifeboat to the full force of waves hitting the beam, which significantly increases the risk of the craft rolling to the point of capsizing.

Q17. With the water sprinkler system and the air system turned on and all hatches shut, an enclosed survival craft will provide protection from:

- A) Heavy rain only
- B) External fire and a toxic gas environment
- C) Shark attacks
- D) High pressure waves only

Correct Answer: B (External fire and a toxic gas environment)

Explanation: Enclosed survival craft feature air support systems and water spray protection to provide a secure environment, protecting occupants from the intense thermal radiation of an external oil fire and preventing the ingress of hazardous smoke or toxic gases.

Q18. Which data is NOT painted on the bow of a lifeboat?

- A) Dimensions of the boat
- B) Carrying capacity of persons
- C) Total weight of the boat with full load
- D) Name of the parent vessel

Correct Answer: C (Total weight of the boat with full load)

Explanation: Dimensions, capacity, and ship name are painted, while weight details are on the builder's plate

Q19. Every lifeboat requires to be launched into the water and maneuvered at least once in every:

- A) Month
- B) Two months
- C) Three months
- D) Six months

Correct Answer: C (Three months)

Explanation: SOLAS requirements state that every lifeboat shall be launched with its assigned operating crew aboard and maneuvered in the water at least once every three months as part of mandatory drills.

Q20. The mandatory distress pyrotechnics required to be kept inside a lifeboat container are:

- A) Rocket parachutes + Hand flares + Buoyant smoke signals
- B) Rocket parachutes + Line throwers
- C) Sound signals + Strobe lights
- D) Red flags and matches

Correct Answer: A (Rocket parachutes + Hand flares + Buoyant smoke signals)

Explanation: The LSA Code specifies that a lifeboat must be equipped with rocket parachute flares, hand flares, and buoyant smoke signals to ensure survivors have various means of visual distress signaling for both day and night detection.



- A) Immediately order everyone to jump into the sea
- B) Wait for calmer weather or specific instructions before transferring personnel
- C) Tie the lifeboat directly to the rescue ship's propeller
- D) Turn off the lifeboat engine and abandon helm controls

Correct Answer: B (Wait for calmer weather or specific instructions before transferring personnel)

Explanation: Transferring personnel from a lifeboat to a rescue vessel in heavy seas is extremely dangerous; the person in charge must prioritize safety and await favorable conditions or specific instructions to prevent injury or loss of life.

Q22. Which of the following survival equipment items is considered consumable?

- A) Food rations
- B) Drinking water
- C) Anti-seasickness tablets
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Consumable items in survival equipment include food, water, and medication (such as anti-seasickness tablets), which are depleted during use and must be replenished or maintained for ongoing survival.

Q23. Which will be the worst of emergencies that you would face if it happens at sea?

- A) Loss of Wi-Fi
- B) Foundering (Sinking completely)
- C) Minor galley fire
- D) Generator tripping

Correct Answer: B (Foundering (Sinking completely))

Explanation: Foundering is the most severe maritime emergency as it involves the total loss of the vessel's buoyancy, requiring an immediate and total abandonment of the ship into survival craft.

Q24. A life jacket has which of the following mandatory safety attachments on it?

- A) Retro-reflective tape + Whistle + Light
- B) Line thrower + Mirror
- C) Compass + Knife
- D) Flare gun + EPIRB

Correct Answer: A (Retro-reflective tape + Whistle + Light)

Explanation: SOLAS regulations require all life jackets to be fitted with a whistle for audible signaling, a light to assist in night-time location, and retro-reflective material to enhance visibility in search and rescue operations.

Q25. Which of these requirements regarding the launching and recovery arrangements for rescue boats corresponds to Solas regulations?

- A) They must take at least 30 minutes to prepare
- B) Embarkation and launching arrangements shall be such that the rescue boat can be boarded and launched in less than 5 minutes
- C) They must only be handled by the Captain
- D) They can only be launched when the ship is completely stopped

Correct Answer: B (Embarkation and launching arrangements shall be such that the rescue boat can be boarded and

Explanation: To ensure rapid response in emergency recovery operations, SOLAS mandates that rescue boat embarkation and



Q26. When a person who has fallen overboard is being picked up by a rescue boat, how should the boat normally approach with the wind?

- A) Directly from astern
- B) Just off the bow and the victim to leeward
- C) With wind directly on the beam and victim to windward
- D) At full speed from windward side

Correct Answer: B (Just off the bow and the victim to leeward)

Explanation: A rescue boat should approach a person in the water with the windward side providing a lee; the victim should be positioned to leeward to prevent the boat from drifting onto the casualty.

Q27. A person has fallen overboard and is being picked up with a rescue boat. If the person appears in immediate danger of drowning, how should the rescue boat maneuver?

- A) Perform an elegant, slow Williamson turn
- B) Make the most direct and safest immediate approach
- C) Wait for sunrise
- D) Circle the person three times before stopping

Correct Answer: B (Make the most direct and safest immediate approach)

Explanation: In cases of immediate danger, the rescue boat must prioritize the most direct and safest approach to extract the victim from the water as quickly as possible to prevent drowning.

Q28. In moderate sea conditions, when loaded with its full complement of persons and equipment, the recovery time of a fast rescue boat (FRB) shall be not more than:

- A) 3 minutes
- B) 5 minutes
- C) 6 minutes
- D) 10 minutes

Correct Answer: C (6 minutes)

Explanation: SOLAS standards for Fast Rescue Boats (FRB) stipulate that they must be capable of being recovered in moderate sea conditions within 6 minutes when fully loaded with crew and equipment.

Q29. Inflatable rescue boats shall be marked externally with which information?

- A) Total weight of rubber used
- B) Serial number, the maker's name, and the date of manufacture
- C) Next port of call
- D) Names of all the crew members on board

Correct Answer: B (Serial number, the maker's name, and the date of manufacture)

Explanation: Inflatable rescue boats must be clearly marked with manufacturing details, including the serial number, manufacturer's name, and date of manufacture, for maintenance tracking and safety certification.



- A) Heavy Fuel Oil (HFO)
- B) Gasoline / Petrol
- C) Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG)
- D) Marine Gas Oil (MGO) only

Correct Answer: B (Gasoline / Petrol)

Explanation: The outboard engines of Fast Rescue Boats are designed for high-performance operation and are approved to use gasoline, which provides the necessary power-to-weight ratio for rapid rescue deployment.

Practice Set 7

Q1. The Public Address (PA) system shall be a loudspeaker installation enabling the broadcast of emergency messages into:

- A) Only the bridge and engine room
- B) All spaces where crew members or passengers, or both, are normally present, and to muster stations
- C) Only the cargo control room
- D) Open decks only

Correct Answer: B (All spaces where crew members or passengers, or both, are normally present, and to muster stations)

Explanation: The Public Address system is a crucial communication tool mandated by SOLAS to ensure emergency instructions are clearly broadcast to all muster stations and areas where crew or passengers are located.

Q2. The liquid inside a standard wet card magnetic compass is a specific mixture of:

- A) Seawater and kerosene
- B) Distilled water and pure ethylene alcohol
- C) Glycerin and heavy oil
- D) Pure acetone

Correct Answer: B (Distilled water and pure ethylene alcohol)

Explanation: The compass card in a liquid-filled magnetic compass is suspended in a mixture of distilled water and pure ethylene alcohol, which prevents freezing at low temperatures and ensures smooth damping of the card.

Q3. What does the standard graphical IMO symbol showing a boat being lowered horizontally by two wires indicate?

- A) Launch life raft
- B) Lower rescue boat
- C) Evacuation slide usage
- D) Fast rescue boat recovery

Correct Answer: B (Lower rescue boat)

Explanation: The IMO graphical symbol depicting a boat being lowered horizontally by two wires is the standard safety sign for a rescue boat, used to indicate the location and operation of the launch gear.



- A) Victim to windward
- B) Victim to leeward
- C) Boat moving astern
- D) Engine completely turned off 50 meters away

Correct Answer: B (Victim to leeward)

Explanation: Approaching a casualty to leeward is essential to create a sheltered area (a lee) and prevent the rescue boat from being pushed by the wind directly onto the person in the water.

Q5. All rescue boats shall be capable of being launched, utilizing painters where necessary, with the parent ship making headway at speeds up to:

- A) 2 knots in heavy seas
- B) 5 knots in calm water
- C) 10 knots in calm water
- D) 12 knots under any condition

Correct Answer: B (5 knots in calm water)

Explanation: To ensure rescue boats can be effectively deployed while the ship is moving, they must be capable of launching and maneuvering at speeds of at least 5 knots in calm water.

Q6. An inflatable life raft is stabilized against flipping and wind drift primarily by:

- A) heavy iron keel
- B) The water-filled stability pockets underneath it
- C) Rigging lines on top
- D) The weight of its canopy

Correct Answer: B (The water-filled stability pockets underneath it)

Explanation: Water-filled stability pockets, also known as water pockets or bags, located under the life raft fill with seawater immediately upon inflation to add weight and lower the center of gravity, preventing capsizing.

Q7. After abandoning ship, survivors inside a survival craft must be given:

- A) Water and food immediately on boarding
- B) No fresh water for the first 24 hours (unless injured)
- C) Double water rations to handle panic
- D) Seawater to preserve fresh water

Correct Answer: B (No fresh water for the first 24 hours (unless injured))

Explanation: To prevent dehydration, initial rationing protocols often restrict fresh water intake during the first 24 hours unless the survivor is suffering from severe heat or injury, as the body's metabolic demand is lower.

Q8. Every inflatable life raft, inflatable life jacket, and Hydrostatic Release Unit (HRU) shall be professionally serviced at an approved station every:

- A) 6 months
- B) 12 months (every year)
- C) 24 months
- D) 5 years

Correct Answer: B (12 months (every year))



Q9. How much fresh water is available per person in a standard Lifeboat container?

- A) 1.5 Liters
- B) 2 Liters
- C) 3 Liters
- D) 5 Liters

Correct Answer: C (3 Liters)

Explanation: In accordance with LSA Code requirements, every lifeboat must be provided with 3 liters of fresh water for every person the boat is permitted to accommodate.

Q10. If you have to abandon ship into cold water, what type of clothing preparation is best?

- A) Strip down to minimal light clothing to swim faster
- B) Put on extra layers of clothing, preferably with a waterproof layer on top
- C) Wear wool clothing only without any footwear
- D) Put on your heavy work boiler suit only

Correct Answer: B (Put on extra layers of clothing, preferably with a waterproof layer on top)

Explanation: In cold water, survival depends on thermal insulation; wearing multiple layers of clothing, particularly a waterproof outer layer, helps trap heat and protects the skin from rapid cooling.

Q11. How much fresh water is provided per person inside an inflatable life raft equipment pack?

- A) 1 Liter
- B) 1.5 Liters
- C) 3 Liters
- D) 0.5 Liter

Correct Answer: B (1.5 Liters)

Explanation: The LSA Code mandates that an inflatable life raft equipment pack must contain 1.5 liters of fresh water per person, which is sufficient to sustain survival until rescue occurs.

Q12. What critical step should be done before throwing a throw-overboard life raft pack into the sea, after securing its painter to a strong point?

- A) Inflate it on deck first
- B) Check that there is nothing and no casualties in the sea directly below
- C) Cut the container bands with an axe
- D) Throw the oars first

Correct Answer: B (Check that there is nothing and no casualties in the sea directly below)

Explanation: It is critical to ensure the area below the launching position is clear of persons or debris before throwing an inflatable life raft to prevent injury to those in the water.

Q13. How should the painter of a life raft fitted with a hydrostatic release unit (HRU) be secured to the ship structure?

- A) Shackled directly onto the main steel deck without any links
- B) Secured via a weak link to a secure part of the ship
- C) Wrapped loosely around the railing tubes
- D) Kept completely unattached until launching



Explanation: The painter is secured to the ship via a weak link to ensure that if the ship sinks, the raft will automatically detach once the tension exceeds the weak link's breaking strength, preventing the raft from being pulled down by the ship.

Q14. Referring to the Solas convention, how often should every crew member on a cargo ship participate in at least one abandon ship drill and one fire drill?

- A) Weekly
- B) Monthly
- C) Every two months
- D) Every six months

Correct Answer: B (Monthly)

Explanation: SOLAS regulation III/19 requires that every crew member participate in at least one abandon ship drill and one fire drill every month to maintain competency in emergency procedures.

Q15. What constitutes the formal abandon ship signal?

- A) Any crew member shouting on the PA system
- B) A verbal or alarms command given only by the Master or his deputy
- C) The chief engineer stopping the main engine
- D) The sounding of the continuous fog horn automatically

Correct Answer: B (A verbal or alarms command given only by the Master or his deputy)

Explanation: The abandon ship signal is a formal emergency command issued only by the Master or their authorized deputy to ensure the decision is deliberate, documented, and fully coordinated.

Q16. What are the core physical/smothering characteristics of Carbon Dioxide (CO2) when used for firefighting?

- A) It displaces oxygen
- B) It is in itself not dangerous (not toxic/poisonous in low levels)
- C) It is heavier than oxygen
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Carbon Dioxide is an effective fire extinguishing agent because it is heavier than air, displaces oxygen, and is non-conductive, making it suitable for electrical fires; however, it is an asphyxiant requiring caution.

Q17. What is an immersion suit?

- A) lightweight swimming outfit for divers
- B) Special protective clothing to insulate and protect the wearer from the effects of being in a cold sea
- C) A chemical splash suit used for cargo sampling
- D) A boiler suit used for cleaning fuel tanks

Correct Answer: B (Special protective clothing to insulate and protect the wearer from the effects of being in a cold sea)

Explanation: An immersion suit is a protective garment designed to provide high thermal insulation to a person, significantly delaying the onset of hypothermia in cold sea water.



- A) By guessing from its length
- B) The number of persons should be clearly stated on the outside of the boat's bow
- C) By looking up the vessel's crew list only
- D) It is written inside the main engine casing plate only

Correct Answer: B (The number of persons should be clearly stated on the outside of the boat's bow)

Explanation: The capacity of a lifeboat is a mandatory safety specification and must be clearly and permanently marked on the exterior of the boat to allow for rapid verification during emergencies.

Q19. Match the term "immersion suit" with its most fundamental functional objective:

- A) High speed swimming visibility
- B) Protection against cold/hypothermia
- C) Protection against shark bites
- D) Fire protection suit

Correct Answer: B (Protection against cold/hypothermia)

Explanation: The primary design objective of an immersion suit is to reduce the loss of body heat in cold water, thereby preventing hypothermia and extending the survival time of the wearer.

Q20. What is one of the most dangerous psychological or physiological states a survivor in cold water may suffer from?

- A) Hyperventilation only
- B) Hypothermia
- C) Seasickness only
- D) Dehydration within 5 minutes

Correct Answer: B (Hypothermia)

Explanation: Hypothermia is the most significant physiological risk in cold water environments; it occurs when the body's core temperature drops, leading to impaired function and eventually death if not treated.

Q21. Standard Solas life jackets must have which auxiliary components attached to them?

- A) Compass and flare
- B) Light, whistle, and retro-reflective tape
- C) Knife and signaling mirror
- D) GPS tracker and radio

Correct Answer: B (Light, whistle, and retro-reflective tape)

Explanation: LSA requirements mandate that life jackets must include a light, a whistle, and retro-reflective tape to improve the ability of search and rescue teams to spot the wearer.

Q22. LSA stands for:

- A) Life Saving Arrangement
- B) Life Saving Appliance
- C) Low Safety Area
- D) Life Security Apparatus

Correct Answer: B (Life Saving Appliance)

Explanation: LSA is the standard maritime acronym for Life Saving Appliance, which encompasses all equipment required under the SOLAS Convention to ensure the safety of lives at sea.



- A) It must be cut with a hack-saw
- B) Remove the toggle pin which will instantly release the painter eye
- C) Unwind 50 meters of rope from the drum
- D) It cannot be released and must be dragged along

Correct Answer: B (Remove the toggle pin which will instantly release the painter eye)

Explanation: The painter is attached using a slip-toggle or a quick-release mechanism that allows the crew to manually detach the painter instantly once the lifeboat is waterborne and clear of the ship's side.

Q24. The limit switch of a lifeboat davit will stop the davit arms automatically before they reach their hard stowed position at a distance of:

- A) 6 inches
- B) 12 inches
- C) 24 inches
- D) 36 inches

Correct Answer: B (12 inches)

Explanation: Davit limit switches are safety devices that cut power to the davit winch motor before the boat hits the davit arms, with a standard clearance of approximately 12 inches (0.3 meters).

Q25. On a passenger ship, the formal muster of newly embarked passengers must be carried out:

- A) Within 12 hours of arrival at the next port
- B) Within 24 hours of leaving the port
- C) Only if the sea becomes rough
- D) Exactly 3 days into the voyage

Correct Answer: B (Within 24 hours of leaving the port)

Explanation: Safety regulations for passenger ships require that a muster of newly embarked passengers must take place before or immediately after departure, but no later than 24 hours after arrival.

Q26. You are at sea inside an inflatable life raft in high latitudes. The greatest physical threat to your life is:

- A) Lack of food rations
- B) Hypothermia caused by cold temperatures
- C) Sea predators and sharks
- D) Heavy rain damaging the canopy fabric

Correct Answer: B (Hypothermia caused by cold temperatures)

Explanation: In high latitudes, the extreme cold of the water leads to rapid heat loss; therefore, protection against hypothermia is the most critical survival priority for those in life rafts.

Q27. You are on a survival craft broadcasting a distress message via VHF. What information is absolutely essential for rescue forces to locate you?

- A) The ship's cargo manifest details
- B) Your precise position by latitude and longitude
- C) The name of the shipowner
- D) The number of years you have spent at sea

Correct Answer: B (Your precise position by latitude and longitude)

Explanation: Accurate position coordinates (latitude and longitude) are the single most important piece of information for rescue



~~Q28. Which statement concerning locating signals within the GMDSS infrastructure is FALSE?~~

- A) Locating signals are intended to guide rescuers to the scene
- B) SARTs provide radar locating signals
- C) Locating signals are transmitted by Survival Craft VHF handheld transceivers automatically on 406 MHz
- D) Radiolocation tracking relies on transponders

Correct Answer: C (Locating signals are transmitted by Survival Craft VHF handheld transceivers automatically on 406 MHz)

Explanation: SARTs or EPIRBs transmit tracking data, not standard handheld VHF speech channels

Q29. The most important reason for taking anti-seasickness pills (ASAP) as soon as possible after entering a life raft is to:

- A) Help you sleep comfortably
- B) Prevent the critical loss of body moisture/water by vomiting
- C) Improve your vision in low light
- D) Increase your internal body temperature

Correct Answer: B (Prevent the critical loss of body moisture/water by vomiting)

Explanation: Seasickness induces vomiting, which causes rapid and critical fluid loss in the body. Taking medication immediately helps maintain hydration levels, which are vital for long-term survival.

Q30. What visual signal indication does an Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon (EPIRB) give when it is activated?

- A) Continuous green smoke emission
- B) A built-in strobe light flashes continuously
- C) An audible siren sounds loudly
- D) It projects a laser beam into the sky

Correct Answer: B (A built-in strobe light flashes continuously)

Explanation: Once activated, an EPIRB sends a distress signal via satellite and simultaneously flashes an integrated high-intensity strobe light to assist visual location by aircraft or vessels at night.